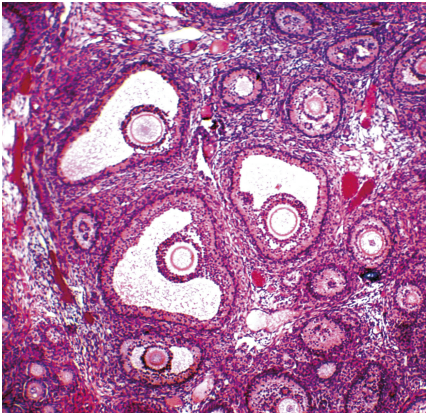




THIS IS **DAY 8 OF YOUR MENSTRUAL CYCLE**
272 days to go

WHAT'S HAPPENING INSIDE

Here, three developing ovarian follicles can be seen in white. The inner circle of each is the egg. Of the follicles shown, it is likely that only one will be fully mature at [ovulation](#) and release an egg.

“By the end of this week you’re likely to have ovulated. It’s a good idea to know the signs that indicate you’re at your most fertile.”

This is week two of your cycle. You will probably ovulate by the end of this week and will therefore be fertile. Since sperm can survive for three days inside you and an egg lives for 12-24 hours after ovulation, the window for an egg to be fertilized is 6 days. However, since the day of ovulation varies from day 12 to day 16, (approximately day 14 of a 28-day cycle), the fertile phase is regarded as spanning around 8 days. If you have regular periods, ovulation can be easier to track, but you may want to look for natural signs (see [image](#)) or use an ovulation kit. The kit tests urine to detect a surge in LH, the hormone that triggers egg release.

After a positive test you should ovulate 12–16 hours later. Results are about 99 percent accurate, but occasionally the result is a false positive or a false negative. If your result was negative, test the next day. Once you have a positive result, stop testing for that month.

While they are useful, testing kits are expensive and can be counterproductive because they make sex more clinical and less enjoyable. The best way to conceive is to have sex regularly.

CHANGES DURING THE MENSTRUAL CYCLE

Body temperature rises sharply after ovulation. Basal body temperature (when you first wake in the morning) rises slightly.

Cervical secretions start off moist and sticky in the days leading up to ovulation, then become wetter and stretchy.

Lower abdominal pain is experienced by some women.